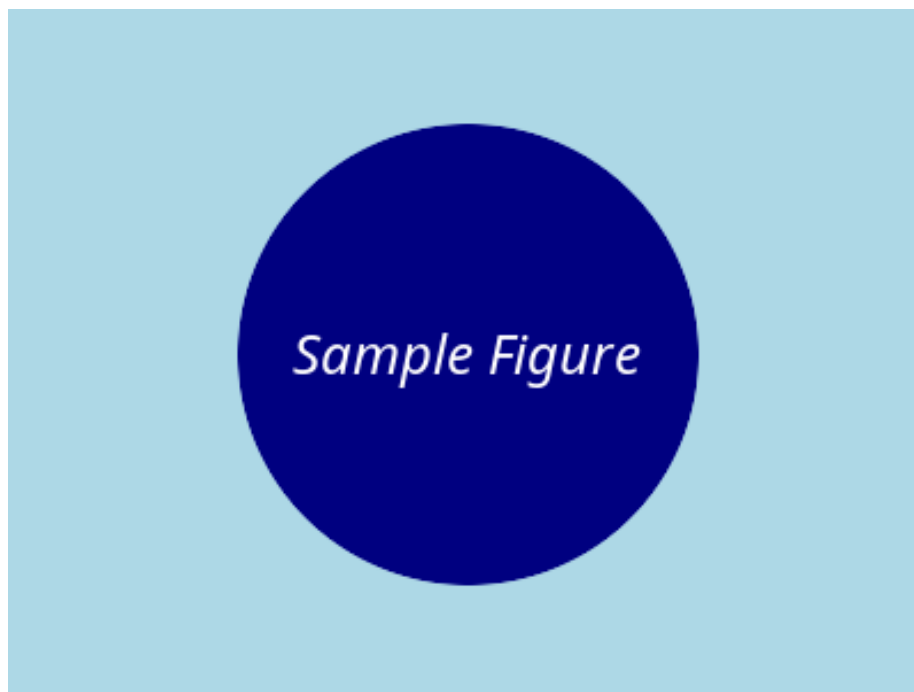


## Graphical Abstract

**MyST Markdown with the Elsevier CAS and elsarticle Classes: Feature Reference and Template Examples**

Alan E. Lujan, Christopher D. Carroll, Matthew N. White



## Highlights

### **MyST Markdown with the Elsevier CAS and elsarticle Classes: Feature Reference and Template Examples**

Alan E. Lujan, Christopher D. Carroll, Matthew N. White

- MyST Markdown enables reproducible scientific writing
- Seamless export to multiple journal formats
- Rich mathematical and scientific notation support

# MyST Markdown with the Elsevier CAS and elsarticle Classes: Feature Reference and Template Examples<sup>\*,\*\*</sup>

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## Abstract

This article demonstrates MyST Markdown integration with Elsevier’s CAS and elsarticle classes, covering typography, math, cross-references, admonitions, proofs, tables, figures, and code blocks.

*Keywords:* MyST Markdown, Elsevier, LaTeX, CAS Template, Scientific Publishing, Reproducible Research

*JEL:* D14; C61; G11

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## Summary

One Markdown source produces both Elsevier layouts and a website.

*Beware of bugs in the above code; I have only proved it correct, not tried it.*

— Donald E. Knuth

## 1. Introduction

This document demonstrates the full integration of MyST Markdown ([Cockett et al., 2024](#)) with Elsevier’s CAS templates. MyST provides a powerful authoring experience while maintaining compatibility with traditional LaTeX journal requirements ([Lamport, 1994](#)). The template renders to PDF for camera-ready submission and to HTML for the project website; author identifiers (ORCID) and persistent links (DOI) propagate through both pipelines.

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<sup>\*\*</sup>To everyone who has fought a LaTeX class file at midnight.

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### 1.1. Background

Scientific publishing has traditionally relied on LaTeX for high-quality typesetting (Krewinkel and Winkler, 2017). However, the learning curve and complexity of LaTeX can be a barrier for authors who write outside it day to day. MyST Markdown bridges this gap by providing:

1. A familiar Markdown syntax based on CommonMark (Gruber, 2004)
2. Rich scientific features (equations, citations, cross-references)
3. Export to multiple formats including PDF via LaTeX

Reproducible research workflows have become increasingly important, with tools like Jupyter Notebooks (Kluyver et al., 2016) enabling literate programming approaches.

#### Note

**About this document:** This article is both a feature reference and a test file for the Elsevier MyST template. Every feature shown here should render correctly in the web preview and in all six PDF exports, under CAS and elsarticle alike.

## 2. Typography Features

This section demonstrates MyST Markdown typography features and how they render in the PDF output.

### 2.1. Inline Formatting

Standard inline formatting includes **bold text**, *italic text*, and `inline code`. You can also use ~~striketrough text~~ and underlined text for special emphasis.

For chemical formulas, use subscripts: H<sub>2</sub>O, CO<sub>2</sub>, C<sub>6</sub>H<sub>12</sub>O<sub>6</sub>. For ordinals and exponents, use superscripts: the 4<sup>th</sup> of July, 1<sup>st</sup> place,  $x^2 + y^2 = r^2$ .

### 2.2. Line Breaks

The world's shortest poem demonstrates line breaks:

Fleas

Adam

Had 'em.

—Strickland Gillilan

### 2.3. Quotations

Block quotes are useful for highlighting important passages:

We know what we are, but know not what we may be.

William Shakespeare, Hamlet

The important thing is not to stop questioning. Curiosity has its own reason for existing.

#### 2.4. Definition Lists

MyST supports definition lists for glossaries or term explanations:

**MyST** Markedly Structured Text, a markdown flavor for scientific writing

**LaTeX** A document preparation system for high-quality typesetting

**jtex** A Jinja-based templating system for LaTeX documents

**CAS** Complex Article Service, the Elsevier workflow the cas-sc and cas-dc classes target

#### 2.5. Footnotes

MyST supports footnotes<sup>1</sup> which are automatically numbered and placed at the end of the document. You can have multiple footnotes<sup>2</sup> throughout your text.

#### 2.6. Task Lists

Task lists can track progress (rendered as bullet points in LaTeX):

- Create template structure
- Add typography examples
- Add math demonstrations
- Add proof environments
- ☐ Submit to journal
- ☐ Celebrate publication!

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<sup>1</sup>This is a footnote demonstrating the feature. Footnotes can contain **formatted text** and even `code`.

<sup>2</sup>Another footnote with additional information. Footnotes are essential for academic writing.

In the middle of difficulty lies opportunity.

Albert Einstein

### 3. Mathematical Content

The templates support full LaTeX math with custom macros defined in frontmatter.

#### 3.1. Inline Mathematics

Inline math like  $E = mc^2$  or  $\mathbb{E}[X] = \mu$  sets in running text without extra markup. Using our custom macros: for  $x \in \mathbb{R}$ , we have  $\text{Var}(X) = \mathbb{E}[X^2] - (\mathbb{E}[X])^2$  and  $\text{Cov}(X, Y) = \mathbb{E}[XY] - \mathbb{E}[X]\mathbb{E}[Y]$ .

#### 3.2. Display Equations

The quadratic formula:

$$x = \frac{-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}}{2a} \quad (1)$$

Maxwell's equations in differential form:

$$\begin{aligned} \nabla \cdot \mathbf{E} &= \frac{\rho}{\varepsilon_0} \\ \nabla \cdot \mathbf{B} &= 0 \\ \nabla \times \mathbf{E} &= -\frac{\partial \mathbf{B}}{\partial t} \\ \nabla \times \mathbf{B} &= \mu_0 \mathbf{J} + \mu_0 \varepsilon_0 \frac{\partial \mathbf{E}}{\partial t} \end{aligned} \quad (2)$$

The Bellman equation for dynamic programming, where the policy is the maximizing action  $a^*(s) = \operatorname{argmax}_a \{R(s, a) + \gamma \sum_{s'} P(s'|s, a)V(s')\}$ :

$$V(s) = \max_a \left\{ R(s, a) + \gamma \sum_{s'} P(s'|s, a)V(s') \right\} \quad (3)$$

Equations can be cross-referenced: see (1) for the quadratic formula and (2) for Maxwell's equations.

### 4. Proofs and Theorems

MyST supports formal mathematical environments using proof directives. These are essential for mathematical and theoretical papers.

#### 4.1. Definitions

**Definition 4.1** (Convergent Sequence). A sequence  $(a_n)$  in  $\mathbb{R}$  is said to be convergent if there exists a number  $L \in \mathbb{R}$  such that for every  $\varepsilon > 0$ , there exists  $N \in \mathbb{N}$  such that for all  $n > N$ :

$$|a_n - L| < \varepsilon \quad (4)$$

We write  $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} a_n = L$ .

**Definition 4.2** (Continuous Function). A function  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is continuous at a point  $c$  if for every  $\varepsilon > 0$ , there exists  $\delta > 0$  such that:

$$|x - c| < \delta \implies |f(x) - f(c)| < \varepsilon \quad (5)$$

#### 4.2. Theorems

**Theorem 4.1** (Squeeze Theorem). Let  $(a_n)$ ,  $(b_n)$ , and  $(c_n)$  be sequences such that  $a_n \leq b_n \leq c_n$  for all  $n \geq N_0$ . If

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} a_n = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} c_n = L \quad (6)$$

then  $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} b_n = L$ .

**Theorem 4.2** (Fundamental Theorem of Calculus). Let  $f$  be continuous on  $[a, b]$  and let  $F$  be defined by  $F(x) = \int_a^x f(t) dt$ . Then:

1.  $F$  is continuous on  $[a, b]$
2.  $F$  is differentiable on  $(a, b)$  and  $F'(x) = f(x)$
3.  $\int_a^b f(x) dx = F(b) - F(a)$

#### 4.3. Proofs

*Proof. Proof of Theorem 4.1.* Let  $\varepsilon > 0$  be given. Since  $a_n \rightarrow L$  and  $c_n \rightarrow L$ , there exist  $N_1, N_2 \in \mathbb{N}$  such that:

- $|a_n - L| < \varepsilon$  for all  $n > N_1$
- $|c_n - L| < \varepsilon$  for all  $n > N_2$

Let  $N = \max\{N_0, N_1, N_2\}$ . For  $n > N$ , we have:

$$L - \varepsilon < a_n \leq b_n \leq c_n < L + \varepsilon \quad (7)$$

Thus  $|b_n - L| < \varepsilon$ , completing the proof. □

#### 4.4. Lemmas and Corollaries

**Lemma 4.3** (Triangle Inequality). For all  $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$ , we have  $|x + y| \leq |x| + |y|$ .

**Corollary 4.3.1.** If  $(b_n)$  is squeezed between two sequences converging to zero, then  $b_n \rightarrow 0$ .

#### 4.5. Remarks and Examples

**Remark 4.1.** *The proof directives (Definition 4.1, Theorem 4.1) are automatically numbered and can be cross-referenced throughout the document.*

**Example 4.1** (Convergent Sequence). *The sequence  $a_n = \frac{1}{n}$  converges to 0. For any  $\varepsilon > 0$ , choose  $N > \frac{1}{\varepsilon}$ . Then for  $n > N$ :*

$$\left| \frac{1}{n} - 0 \right| = \frac{1}{n} < \frac{1}{N} < \varepsilon \quad (8)$$

## 5. Admonitions

Admonitions (callouts) are useful for highlighting important information. MyST supports many types:

### Note

This is a note admonition. Use it to highlight supplementary information that readers should be aware of.

### Warning

Use a warning to alert readers about pitfalls or caveats in your methodology.

### Tip

Tips can provide helpful suggestions for readers applying your methods.

### Important

Important information that readers must not miss should go in this type of admonition.

### Hint

Hints can be hidden in dropdowns! Click to reveal.  
This hint contains the secret formula:  $e^{i\pi} + 1 = 0$

### Caution

Caution: Proceed carefully when implementing this algorithm with large datasets.

**Attention**

Attention: New methodology introduced in this section differs from previous work.

**Danger**

**Danger:** Do not run this code in production without proper testing!

**Error**

Error: This approach will fail if the input matrix is singular.

**See Also**

For more information on MyST Markdown features, visit the [MyST documentation](#).

## 6. Code Blocks

Code blocks with syntax highlighting are supported:

```
import numpy as np
from typing import Tuple

def quadratic_formula(a: float, b: float, c: float) ->
    Tuple[float, float]:
    """Solve  $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$  using the quadratic formula."""
    discriminant = b**2 - 4*a*c
    if discriminant < 0:
        raise ValueError("No real solutions")
    x1 = (-b + np.sqrt(discriminant)) / (2*a)
    x2 = (-b - np.sqrt(discriminant)) / (2*a)
    return x1, x2

# Example usage
roots = quadratic_formula(1, -5, 6)
print(f"Roots: {roots}") # Output: (3.0, 2.0)
```

Figure 1: Example Python implementation of the quadratic formula

As shown in Program 1, code can be captioned, numbered, and cross-referenced.

Multiple languages are supported:

```

function quadratic_formula(a, b, c)
    discriminant = b^2 - 4*a*c
    x1 = ( -b + sqrt(discriminant)) / (2*a)
    x2 = ( -b - sqrt(discriminant)) / (2*a)
    return x1, x2
end

```

Figure 2: Julia implementation

## 7. Algorithms

For algorithm pseudocode, use raw LaTeX blocks with the `algorithm` and `algorithmic` environments:

---

### Algorithm 1 Binary Search

---

**Require:** Sorted array  $A[1..n]$ , target value  $x$

**Ensure:** Index  $i$  such that  $A[i] = x$ , or  $-1$  if not found

```

1:  $low \leftarrow 1$ 
2:  $high \leftarrow n$ 
3: while  $low \leq high$  do
4:    $mid \leftarrow \lfloor (low + high)/2 \rfloor$ 
5:   if  $A[mid] = x$  then
6:     return  $mid$ 
7:   else if  $A[mid] < x$  then
8:      $low \leftarrow mid + 1$ 
9:   else
10:     $high \leftarrow mid - 1$ 
11:  end if
12: end while
13: return  $-1$ 

```

---

The algorithm environment provides a float with caption and label for cross-referencing.

## 8. Tables

### 8.1. Markdown Tables

MyST tables convert cleanly to LaTeX:  
Results are summarized in Table 1.

### 8.2. List Tables

List tables provide an alternative syntax useful for complex content:

Table 1: Comparison of numerical methods

| Method   | Accuracy     | Speed  | Memory |
|----------|--------------|--------|--------|
| Baseline | 85.2%        | Fast   | Low    |
| Proposed | <b>92.1%</b> | Medium | Medium |
| Ensemble | 94.3%        | Slow   | High   |
| Oracle   | 98.5%        | N/A    | N/A    |

Table 2: Dataset characteristics

| Dataset  | Training Samples | Test Samples | Features | Classes |
|----------|------------------|--------------|----------|---------|
| MNIST    | 60,000           | 10,000       | 784      | 10      |
| CIFAR-10 | 50,000           | 10,000       | 3,072    | 10      |
| ImageNet | 1,281,167        | 50,000       | 150,528  | 1,000   |

Table 3: Experimental results

| Model               | Accuracy | Precision | Recall | F1-Score |
|---------------------|----------|-----------|--------|----------|
| Logistic Regression | 0.82     | 0.81      | 0.83   | 0.82     |
| Random Forest       | 0.89     | 0.88      | 0.90   | 0.89     |
| Neural Network      | 0.94     | 0.93      | 0.95   | 0.94     |
| Transformer         | 0.97     | 0.96      | 0.97   | 0.97     |

### 8.3. CSV Tables

### 8.4. Raw LaTeX Tables

For complex tables requiring advanced features, use raw LaTeX blocks. The CAS templates include `booktabs`, `multirow`, `makecell`, `array`, and `dcolum` packages:

Table 4: Table features: multi-column headers, aligned decimals, and stacked cells

| Category |                          | Measurements |       |       |
|----------|--------------------------|--------------|-------|-------|
| Type     | Description<br>(details) | Status       | Value | Count |
| Group A  | Item 1                   | Yes          | 12.34 | 100   |
|          | Item 2                   | Yes          | 5.67  | 250   |
|          | Item 3                   | -            | 89.01 | 50    |
| Group B  | Item 4                   | Yes          | 23.45 | 175   |
|          | Item 5                   | -            | 6.78  | 320   |

Features: *booktabs* rules, *multirow* row spanning, *makecell* line breaks, *dcolum* decimal alignment, *array* column formatting.

## 9. Figures and Images

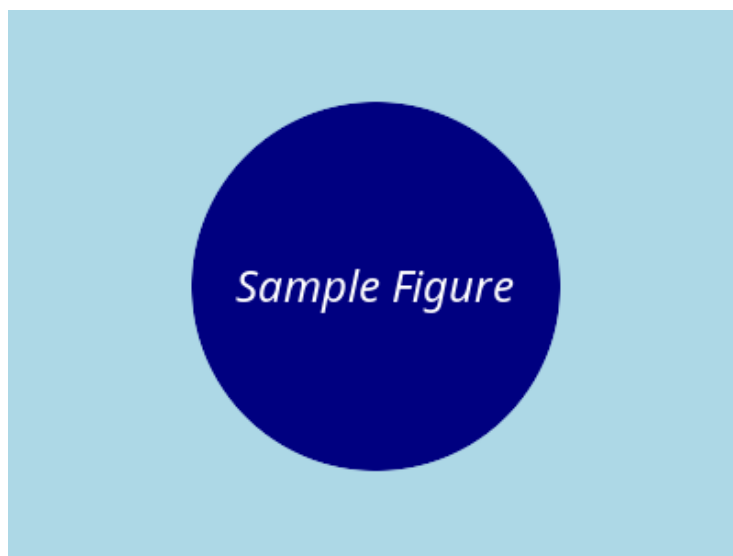


Figure 3: A sample figure demonstrating image support in the template. This figure shows a placeholder image that would typically contain research results or visualizations. Figures are automatically numbered and can be cross-referenced.

As shown in Figure 3, the template properly handles figure placement and captions.

## 10. Cross-References Summary

This document demonstrates various cross-reference capabilities:

- **Equations:** (1), (2), (3)
- **Figures:** Figure 3
- **Tables:** Table 1, Table 2, Table 3
- **Code:** Program 1, Program 2
- **Algorithms:** Algorithm 1 (via raw LaTeX `\ref{alg:binary-search}`)
- **Theorems:** Theorem 4.1, Theorem 4.2
- **Definitions:** Definition 4.1, Definition 4.2
- **Lemmas:** Lemma 4.3
- **Corollaries:** Corollary 4.3.1
- **Examples:** Example 4.1
- **Sections:** Introduction, Typography

## 11. Discussion

This approach enables researchers to write in MyST Markdown while producing publication-ready documents that meet Elsevier's submission requirements.

### 11.1. Advantages

1. **Reproducibility:** Source files are plain text and version-controllable
2. **Flexibility:** Single source exports to HTML, PDF, and other formats
3. **Modern tooling:** Integration with Jupyter, VS Code, and other tools
4. **Rich features:** Full LaTeX math, cross-references, and citations

### 11.2. Limitations

#### **Warning**

Some MyST features render only in HTML output. For PDF, consider using LaTeX-compatible alternatives.

## 12. Conclusion

The Elsevier CAS MyST template provides a modern workflow for scientific writing while maintaining compatibility with traditional journal submission systems. This document has demonstrated:

- Typography: formatting, footnotes, definition lists
- Mathematics: inline, display, custom macros
- Formal environments: definitions, theorems, proofs, examples
- All admonition types
- Multiple table formats
- Code blocks with syntax highlighting
- Figures with cross-referencing
- Citations and bibliography

For questions or contributions, please visit the template repository.

## Appendix A. Supplementary Methods

This appendix provides additional methodological details that support the main text.

### *Appendix A.1. Data Processing*

The data was processed using standard procedures as described in the literature.

This paragraph cites [Mittelbach and Goossens \(2004\)](#), a work no other section cites. It is here to keep the appendix on the bibliography-harvesting path: while this file was pulled in through `parts.appendix`, a citation made here reached the `.tex` and never the `.bib`, and no build step reported anything.

Table B.5: Supplementary parameters

| Parameter | Value | Unit |
|-----------|-------|------|
| Alpha     | 0.05  | -    |
| Beta      | 1.23  | m/s  |
| Gamma     | 456   | kg   |

## Appendix B. Additional Tables

### Declarations

The authors declare no competing interests and did not use generative AI or AI-assisted technologies to prepare this work. This statement exercises the declaration part, which the template prints under the heading Declarations between the CRediT statement and the references.

### Data Availability

No data were used for the research described in the article.

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